

Splitly - Competitor Analysis

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Purpose: Compare direct competitors against the bill-sharing decision criteria and identify the business rationale for Splitly.

1. Executive finding

Shared-expense software is an established category. Splitwise, tricount, Settle Up and Spliit already solve important parts of shared spending: recording expenses, sharing unequal amounts, tracking balances and reducing settlement transfers. Splitwise and Spliit also advertise receipt-scanning capabilities. Splitly should therefore not position itself as the first app that can split a bill, scan a receipt or clear a debt.

The opportunity is a single Vietnam-oriented flow: turn a receipt into editable bill data, assign personal and shared items, explain allocation of receipt adjustments, clear mutual debts where appropriate, and issue a payment-ready VietQR request for the final net amount. The reviewed competitor material does not advertise this full local flow. This is a testable market hypothesis, not a claim that competitors lack every individual capability.

2. Evidence convention

- Y - capability is clearly advertised in the cited evidence.
- P - a related capability is advertised, but not the exact end-to-end criterion.
- U - not confirmed in the reviewed first-party material; this is not proof that it does not exist.
- N - no Vietnam-specific/VietQR capability was found in the reviewed first-party material.

The Splitly column describes the proposed product behavior. It is not a claim that the product is already developed.

3. Capability comparison

Decision criterion	Splitly	Splitwise	tricount	Settle Up	Spliit
Scan receipt	Planned - editable OCR bill draft	Y - Pro receipt scanning	P - attach receipt photo	P - Premium receipt photos; no OCR claim reviewed	Y - beta AI scan
Assign a receipt item to a person	Planned - by-item split	Y - Pro itemization assigns detected items to friends	P - custom expense allocation, not line-item assignment evidenced	P - manual "expense from bill" item entry; assignment not evidenced	P - advanced expense split; item assignment not evidenced
Split a shared item	Planned - equal or item-based allocation	P - item assignment plus custom split settings; exact per-line shared rule not detailed	P - parts or custom amounts at expense level	P - weighted expense splits; exact receipt-line rule not evidenced	P - percentage, shares or amounts at expense level
Allocate VAT, service fee and discount transparently	Planned - explicit adjustment rule and reconciliation	U	U	U	U

Decision criterion	Splitly	Splitwise	tricount	Settle Up	Split
Multiple people pay upfront	Planned decision - assess whether multi-payer receipts belong in the first release	Y - web supports 2+ people paid	U	Y - advertises multiple people paid	U
Optimize or clear final debts	Planned - bilateral debt offset and net balance	Y - simplify debts restructures debts and minimizes payments	Y - settlement suggestions limit transactions	Y - explicitly minimizes transfers	Y - reimbursement optimization
VietQR request for the final amount	Planned - final balance becomes a VietQR request	N - generic payment integrations are advertised, not VietQR	N - payment requests, no VietQR evidence	N - no VietQR evidence	N - no VietQR evidence
Track paid / unpaid and remind	Planned - bill-linked payment status and reminders	Y - payments can be recorded	Y - payment requests and balances	Y - debt can be marked settled and reminders are evidenced	P - reimbursements are advertised; reminder/status detail not evidenced

4. Debt clearing: Splitly and Splitwise

Debt clearing must be treated as a core user benefit, not merely a calculation detail. It removes redundant transfers after several shared bills.

Aspect	Splitly	Splitwise
Current mechanism	An explicit bilateral balance action offsets outstanding bills between two users, starting with the smaller remaining amount, then returns the net debt.	Simplify debts restructures group and friendship debts to minimize the total number of payments without changing each person's total balance.
Mutual-debt example	If A owes B 10,000 VND and B owes A 2,000 VND, the 2,000 VND is offset. The result is one net obligation: A owes B 8,000 VND.	The same economic principle is available. Splitwise can also simplify longer group chains, such as A owing B and B owing C, into fewer payments.
Business implication	Splitly can make the remaining amount visible in the same Vietnamese-localized experience and prepare a VietQR request for the final amount.	Splitwise is the benchmark for debt simplification. Debt clearing alone is not a differentiator.

Splitly proposes a bilateral debt-clearing rule that offsets the smaller reciprocal amount first and leaves one net balance. This is the rule behind the 10,000/2,000 VND example.

Splitwise's official help describes [simplify debts](#) as restructuring debts within groups and across friendships, preserving each person's total while reducing payment count. [Splitwise debt simplification](#)

Positioning consequence: Splitly should match the essential benefit of reduced settlement transfers, then differentiate by tying the final net amount to an explainable receipt result and a local VietQR request. It must not claim debt simplification as unique.

5. Competitor assessment

5.1 Splitwise

Strengths

- Mature shared ledger with groups, unequal/percentage/share splits and balance tracking.
- Pro advertises receipt scanning, detected receipt items and assignment of items to friends.
- Officially supports debt simplification and records payments.

Limitations for Splitly's target situation

- Receipt scanning/itemization is presented as a Pro benefit.
- The reviewed material does not present a Vietnamese-receipt correction flow or a VietQR payment request.

- Its generic global workflow is the benchmark to exceed in local convenience, not a weak alternative to dismiss.

Implication: Splitly must offer a visibly faster receipt-to-final-payment journey for Vietnamese groups; generic balance tracking is insufficient differentiation.

5.2 tricount

Strengths

- Free collaborative tracking with unequal amounts, parts, payment requests, offline support and multi-currency travel features.
- Settlement suggestions reduce the number of repayment transfers.

Limitations for Splitly's target situation

- Current materials promote manual entry and receipt-photo attachment, not OCR itemization.
- No VietQR-specific payment flow was found in the reviewed official pages.

Implication: Do not compete on broad trip tracking. Focus on reducing transcription and payment handoff after an itemized Vietnamese receipt.

5.3 Settle Up

Strengths

- Supports even/weighted splits, multiple people who paid, reminders and minimized transfers.
- Supports a manual "expense from bill" concept and receipt photos.

Limitations for Splitly's target situation

- Receipt photos are listed as Premium; OCR extraction was not established by the reviewed material.
- The reviewed material does not establish transparent allocation of VAT, service charge and discount at receipt-item level.
- No VietQR-specific request is advertised.

Implication: Multiple-upfront-payer bills are a legitimate requirement that Splitly should decide explicitly, not ignore.

5.4 Split

Strengths

- Open source, no account, no ads and no limits reduce adoption friction.
- Advertises beta AI receipt scan, receipt attachments, advanced expense-level splits and reimbursement optimization.

Limitations for Splitly's target situation

- The published material does not establish Vietnamese receipt quality, per-line participant assignment or a receipt-adjustment explanation.
- No VietQR request is advertised.

Implication: Generic AI scan is copyable. The durable value is trustworthy correction, transparent allocation and a payment-ready local settlement.

6. Market gap and rationale for Splitly

The research indicates that a user can find individual components, but not an advertised end-to-end Vietnam-specific experience for the following chain:

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Receipt image
-> editable bill data
-> item and shared-dish assignment
-> transparent VAT/service fee/discount allocation
-> bilateral debt clearing where reciprocal bills exist
-> one final net amount
-> per-person VietQR request
-> paid/unpaid follow-up
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The result is a focused position rather than a broad claim:

Splitly helps Vietnamese groups turn a receipt into transparent personal balances, clear reciprocal debts, and create ready-to-pay VietQR requests.

This integrated flow is valuable because it joins calculation correctness, social transparency and payment completion. It also makes existing debt-clearing behavior more useful: the user sees a single remaining amount after offsetting mutual obligations and can pay that amount without re-entering it in a bank app.

7. Sources

External sources

1. [Splitwise Pro](#) - receipt scan and detected-item assignment (accessed 16 July 2026).
2. [Splitwise product page](#) - flexible splits, balances and payment integrations (accessed 16 July 2026).
3. [Splitwise debt simplification](#) - group/friendship debt restructuring and payment reduction (accessed 16 July 2026).
4. [tricount features](#) and [tricount FAQs](#) - collaboration, custom amounts, receipt-photo attachment and settlement (accessed 16 July 2026).
5. [Settle Up](#) and [Settle Up store features](#) - multiple people paid, receipt photos, reminders and minimized transfers (accessed 16 July 2026).
6. [Spliit features](#) - beta AI scan, receipt images, advanced splits and reimbursements (accessed 16 July 2026).
7. [VietQR.io generate API](#) - QR fields for recipient, amount and transfer information (accessed 16 July 2026).